



Eagles are some of the largest, most powerful birds of prey, with a wingspan of up to 2.5 m (8 ft).

They are skilful hunters and can kill animals that are much heavier than they are. In the Arctic, golden eagles sometimes bring down reindeer, and the harpy eagle of Central and South America uses its long claws to snatch monkeys from the rainforest treetops.

Bald eagles are the USA's national bird. These eagles swoop down over rivers to catch fish, especially salmon. They carry away their glittering prize in curved talons, which can be longer than a grizzly bear's. In Viking myths, an eagle sat at the top of the world and created the winds by beating its wings.